# MobileAgents: Designing and Evaluating a Mobile Multimodal Interface for Controlling Personal AI Agents On the Go

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## CCS Concepts

• **Human-centered computing** → **Interactive systems and tools**; **Empirical studies in HCI**.

## Keywords

multimodal interaction, agent orchestration, transparency, human-in-the-loop, trust, human–AI interaction

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## 1 Introduction: Use Case and Goals

AI Agents are increasingly capable [4]. However, these agents need to be controlled programmatically or through desktop applications. However, the value of these agents is that they can perform tasks while we are away, introducing demand for mobile agentic managers. This was demonstrated by ClawdBot [7], an AI agent controlled via messaging platforms. This underscores the need for a mobile agent platform that enables management of agents with adjustable levels of control and governance.

We designed a mobile-first platform that lets users *bring their own AI agents* and control them on the go through text, voice, and images (Figure 1). Text is sent via a standard conversational interface that supports asynchronous communication with agents. Voice enables hands-free control. Images allow you to send pictures from the phone camera.

Given that these workflows may execute tasks with varying impact and risks, we prioritize having a highly customizable level of control. Certain tasks will be executed completely autonomously, while others may require approval, additional input, or real-time monitoring.

This open-source application is initially targeted at technical people who use agents in their day-to-day lives. Examples may include academics, managing agents for explorative research, summarization, and documentation, or software engineers remotely steering teams of long-running coding agents.

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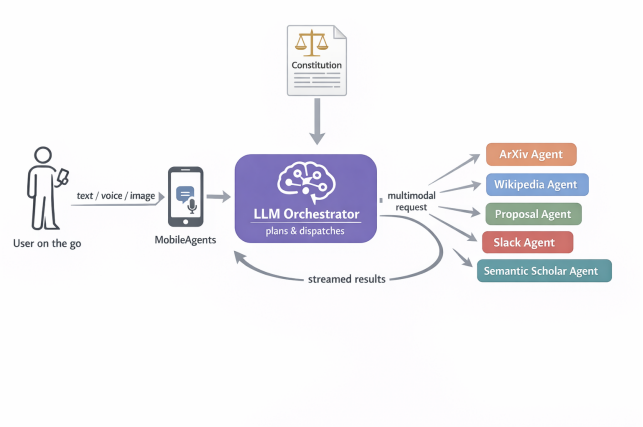



**Figure 1: MobileAgents system overview. A user on the go issues a multimodal request (text, voice, or image) from their phone. The LLM Orchestrator decomposes it into a dependency-aware plan and dispatches tasks across the user's personal agent pool (ArXiv, Wikipedia, Proposal, Slack, Semantic Scholar). Results stream back to the mobile client in real time.**

## 2 Methods: System Design and Implementation

### 2.1 Prototype Overview

MobileAgents is a functional open-source application (Figure 1). All system prompts are available in Appendix C for reproducibility.

### 2.2 Design Rationale

We prioritize human-centred principles, such as reliability, safety, and transparency [6]. We utilized Value Sensitive Design (VSD) [2] to implement design choices based on values.

**V1: Mobility:** "I should be able to reach my agents on the go."

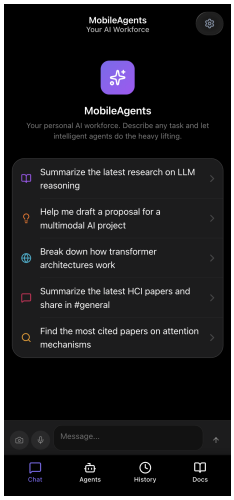
**V2: Control** "I should understand what the agents are doing and be able to supervise them."

**V3: Ease** "MobileAgents should be simple and clear"

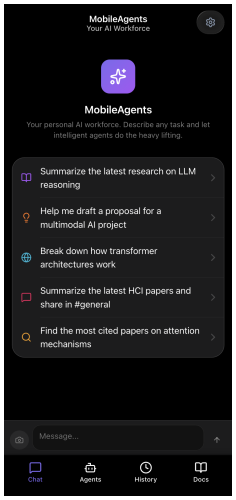
**D1:** Support hand-free voice-only mode, images, and text (Figure 2c, .

**D2:** Propose a plan and ask for confirmation before executing in plan mode, render a real-time execution graph (Figure 3), and support customization of orchestration policy (Appendix C).

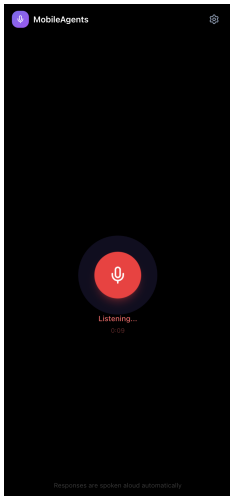
**D3:** Have clear settings, switches for agents, concise responses, clear visualization, and documentation. .




(a) Multimodal mode

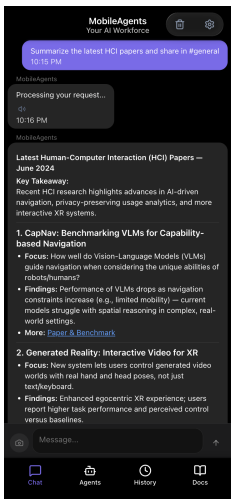



(b) Text + Images mode

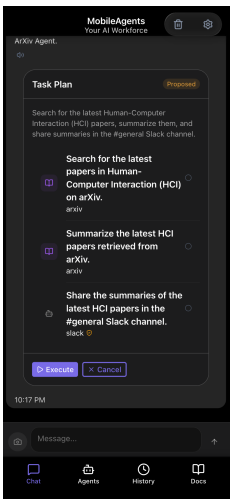



(c) Voice-only mode (listening)

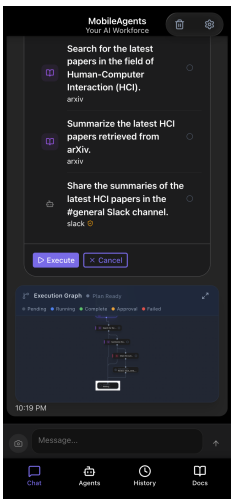
**Figure 2: MobileAgents input modes. (a) Multimodal (b) Text + Images. (c) Voice-only**



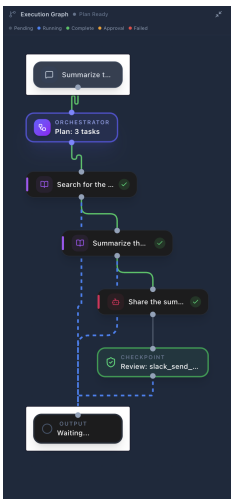

(a) C1: Black Box




(b) C2: Plan Preview




(c) C3: Full Transparency




(d) Live DAG (C3 detail)

**Figure 3: The three transparency configurations and the C3 graph. (a) Black Box (b) Plan Preview (c) Full Transparency (d) Graph Close-up of Full Transparency**

D1 is realized through the modality setting. We support text and images, native voice input/output (push-to-talk), and multimodal (speech-to-text, text, and images) (Figure 2). The text input is the baseline interaction with the multi-agent system and supports all control settings, mobile, and visualizations. Images are added to the text and are useful for capturing physical context (e.g., whiteboard, notes) using the device's camera. The voice-only setting enables hands-free use but does not support plan and transparency controls. Multimodal is similar to text and images mode but also supports speech input that is converted to text, which does not limit plan and transparency modes.

We support D2 via Blackbox, Plan, and Transparency modes (Figure 3; Table 1). Blackbox allows full autonomy; Plan mode requests permission for a plan before execution. Transparency mode builds on plan mode, providing a real-time graph of execution traces for full visibility. Advanced control is available through agent toggles and a natural-language constitution that guides orchestration policy and stylization.

**Table 1: The three transparency configurations compared.**

| Configuration | What the user sees and can do |
|---|---|
| C1: Black Box | Agents auto-execute. |
| C2: Plan Preview | Approve orchestrator's task plan. |
| C3: Transparency | Plan with a real-time graph |

# 3 Methods: Research Question and Evaluation

## 3.1 Research Question

**RQ1:** Is there an efficiency/control tradeoff between black box, plan, and transparency?

**RQ2:** Does the support of multiple modalities improve the mobile-first experience?

**RQ3:** Are users able to guide orchestration behavior through the advanced agent controls (constitution and agent switches) (Figure 4)?

## 3.2 Study Design

The study comprises three sequential phases, counterbalanced using a Latin square.

**Phase 1 — Control (RQ1).** Participants complete the same research task (find recent HCI papers and distribute in Slack) under all control configurations (Table 1)—black box (C1), plan (C2), and transparency (C3)—in counterbalanced order.

**Phase 2 — Modality (RQ2).** Each participant completes a fixed multi-step workflow (find related work and summarize) using all modalities in counterbalanced order: (M1) text and images, (M2) Multimodal (photograph a printed abstract), (M3) voice only (Figure 2). All runs use black-box mode, so modality is the only variable.

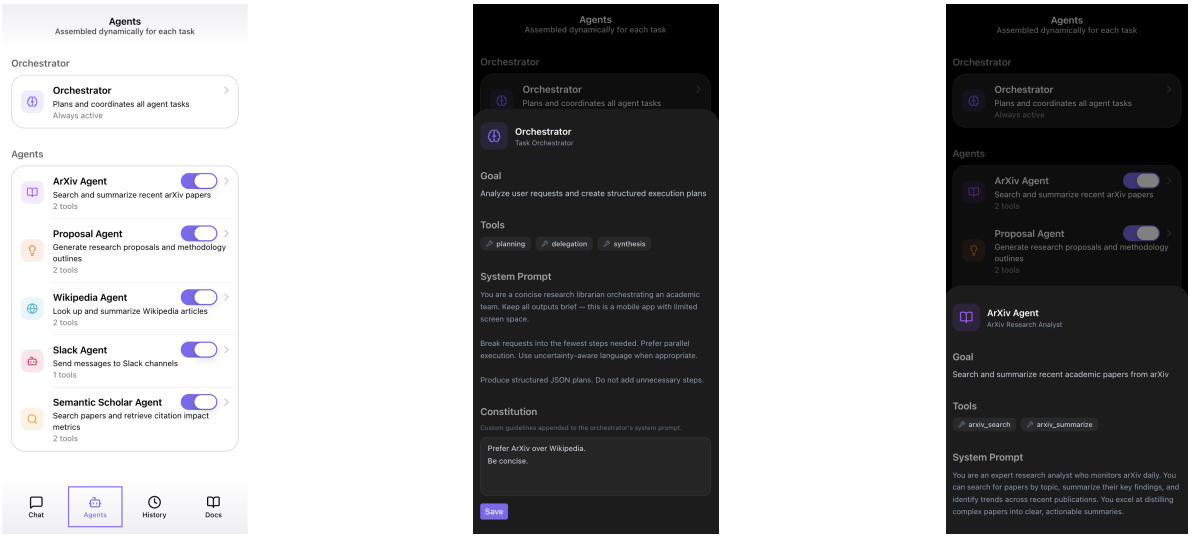
**Phase 3 — Orchestration (RQ3).** Participants are asked: "Configure the system so that it never sends Slack messages without showing you a draft first, and remove any agents you do not want included.' This is a single exploratory session designed to expose whether the constitution and agent toggles can be located, understood, and utilized (Figure 4).

## 3.3 Participants

We recruited 13 volunteers with experience in LLM-based tools.

## 3.4 Evaluation

In phase 1, participants completed a 7-point Likert survey for *control* and *satisfaction*. In phase 2, they fill the NASA Task Load Index [3] to test cognitive load across modalities, and the Single Ease Question [5] for usability. Participants rated the constitution and toggles on a 3-item perceived controllability scale and shared comments on the user experience. The detailed survey is available in Appendix I.




(a) Agents tab (light theme) (b) Orchestrator detail with constitution editor (c) Agent card (ArXiv agent, dark theme)

**Figure 4: Agent management screens. (a) The Agents tab lists the orchestrator (always active) and all registered worker agents with per-agent enable/disable toggles. (b) Tapping the orchestrator opens its detail sheet, showing goal, tools, system prompt, and the editable constitution field. (c) A worker agent card shows its goal, tool names, and full system prompt backstory.**

### 3.5 Metrics

**RQ1 — Efficiency/control tradeoff:**

- Trust, control, and satisfaction (Likert, 1–7).
- Qualitative opinions on over- or under-informed cases.

**RQ2 — Multimodal mobile experience:**

- NASA-TLX composite score and subscale scores per modality.
- Single Ease Question (SEQ).
- Modality preference between different contexts.

**RQ3 — Orchestration policy:**

- Perceived controllability scale score (3-item Likert).
- Qualitatively on discoverability, understanding, and ownership.

## 4 Results

### 4.1 Quantitative Findings

**Table 2: Mean (SD) primary survey scores (1–7 Likert).**

| Metric | C1: Black Box | C2: Plan | C3: Transparency |
|---|---|---|---|
| Trust | 4.3 (1.7) | 5.0 (1.5) | 5.8 (1.0) |
| Control | 3.2 (2.1) | 5.4 (1.3) | 5.7 (1.1) |
| Satisfaction | 4.4 (2.3) | 3.9 (1.1) | 5.8 (1.1) |

Table 2 reveals that Trust and Control monotonically increase from C1 to C3, aligning with an increased interactivity. In terms of satisfaction, C3 scored highest (mean 5.8), whereas C2 performed worst (3.9), indicating that users preferred either full autonomy or high control. We compare the options using a pairwise Wilcoxon signed-rank test with a Bonferroni correction (Table 3). We do not find significant differences in trust between any pairs. However, C2 and C3 are significant relative to C1 in terms of control. For satisfaction, only C3 has significant results over C2.

**Table 3: Post-hoc pairwise Wilcoxon signed-rank tests (Bonferroni-corrected, $k = 3$) and Cohen's $d$ for primary RQ1 metrics. $^{*}p_{\text{bon}} < .05$.**

| Metric | Pair | $W$ | $p_{\text{bon}}$ | $d$ |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Trust | C1-C2 | 16.0 | 0.756 | -0.33 |
| Trust | C1-C3 | 9.5 | 0.120 | -0.69 |
| Trust | C2-C3 | 18.0 | 0.621 | -0.44 |
| Control | C1-C2 | 6.0 | 0.041* | -0.88 |
| Control | C1-C3 | 3.0 | 0.012* | -1.03 |
| Control | C2-C3 | 26.5 | 1.000 | -0.16 |
| Satisfaction | C1-C2 | 29.0 | 1.000 | 0.15 |
| Satisfaction | C1-C3 | 10.0 | 0.234 | -0.58 |
| Satisfaction | C2-C3 | 2.0 | 0.012* | -1.16 |

Table 4 reports on RQ2. blah blah blah

For RQ3, a one-sample Wilcoxon showed controllability ($p$ = .001), effectiveness ($p$ = .016), and ownership ($p$ = .036) above neutral. Discoverability ($p$ = .545) and adoption ($p$ = .717) did not differ from neutral. This suggested the constitution was difficult to find and use. The most trusted feature was the execution graph, while the most important feature missing was an undo functionality.

### 4.2 Qualitative Assessment

Analysis of think-aloud and interviews was grouped into the following:

**Table 4: Mean (SD) SEQ (1–7), NASA-TLX composite and subscales (1–10), and comfort ratings (1–7) per modality.**

| Metric | M1: Text | M2: Image | M3: Voice |
|---|---|---|---|
| SEQ (ease, 1–7) | 4.2 (2.0) | 4.5 (2.1) | 5.4 (1.6) |
| TLX composite | 4.2 (0.6) | 4.1 (0.9) | 4.6 (0.6) |
| Mental | 5.5 (2.6) | 5.7 (2.9) | 5.6 (2.6) |
| Physical | 1.8 (0.9) | 1.8 (0.9) | 2.0 (0.8) |
| Temporal | 2.6 (1.4) | 2.8 (1.7) | 5.0 (1.6) |
| Performance | 7.3 (1.5) | 6.6 (1.5) | 5.8 (2.1) |
| Effort | 3.7 (1.9) | 4.2 (2.1) | 5.6 (1.8) |
| Frustration | 4.5 (1.6) | 3.5 (1.5) | 3.4 (2.1) |
| Felt natural (1–7) | 4.2 (1.1) | 4.9 (1.7) | 4.1 (2.0) |
| OK in public (1–7) | 4.0 (1.6) | 3.3 (1.4) | 2.8 (1.3) |

**Table 5: Mean (SD) customisation items (1–7 Likert), RQ3.**

| Item | Mean (SD) |
|---|---|
| Discoverability | 3.8 (1.6) |
| Mental Model | 4.5 (1.8) |
| Effectiveness | 5.2 (1.4) |
| Controllability | 5.7 (1.0) |
| Ownership | 4.8 (1.1) |
| Adoption | 4.2 (1.5) |

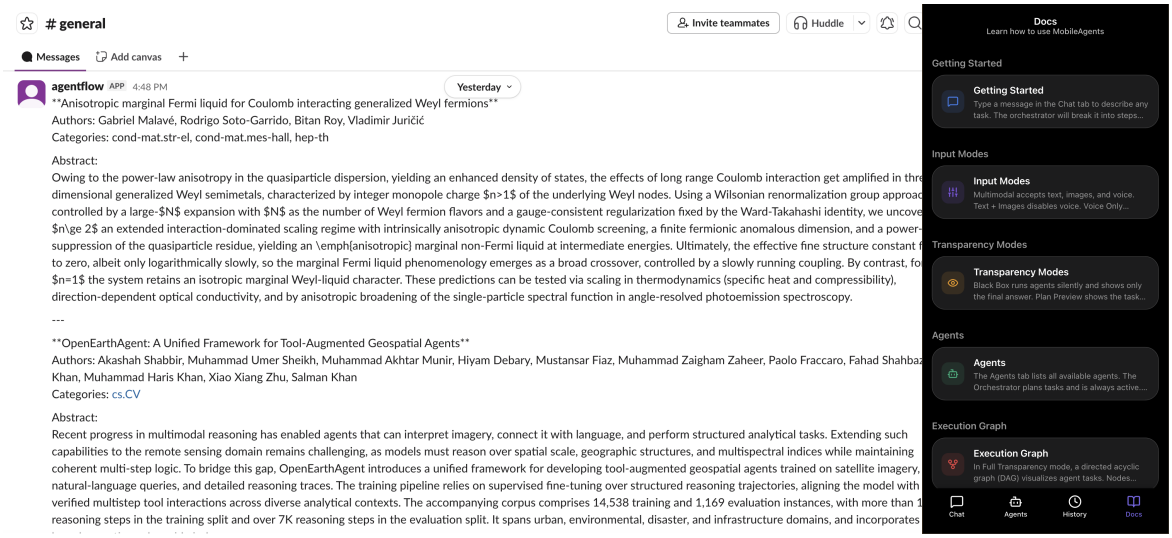
**Intervention is powerful with observation** Participants valued the ability to act while observing the real-time execution of tasks. One participant noted: "The graph reveals wrong directions quickly" This directly validates Amershi et al.'s [1] G2 ("support efficient correction") and G18 ("support efficient dismissal").

**High visibility is valued**

While participants expressed enthusiasm about AI capabilities, trust in their behavior remains low. Thus, the high level of observability in transparency mode is valued, especially in tasks that involve irreversible actions like sending out Slack messages (Figure 5a). This is also supported by the quantitative assessment in RQ1 (Table 2; Table 3).

**Theme 3: Multimodal enables mobile** Participants strongly valued voice for on-the-go use but refused to use it in public spaces. They reported images as useful for quickly capturing notes. Text remains the standard modality for sensitive tasks.

**Theme 4: Constitution is confusing; agent toggles are not.** Users struggled with using the constitution feature as it was unfamiliar (Figure 5b). However, they found the agent toggles simple, easy, and effective to build teams.




(a) Slack output (#general channel) (b) In-app documentation tab

**Figure 5: Slack integration and in-app documentation. (a) Result of a Slack send step after checkpoint approval: two arXiv paper summaries posted to #general by the agentflow bot. (b) The Docs tab provides an in-app guide covering input modes, transparency modes, the agents tab, and execution graph; it is available without leaving the app.**

# 5 Discussion and Future Work

## 5.1 Ethical, Social, and Value-Related Reflection

**Automation vs. Control on mobile.**

Our findings for mobile reinforce the challenges of designing for both automation and control in AI applications. Users want the agent to handle work autonomously, but do not want to give up control when critical. Managing the control expectations is especially difficult when desighing for ambient, on-the-go assistance.

**Privacy and Security**

We recognize that a centralized, agentic manager introduces risks of data storage and prompt injection by malicious agents. Thus, we release the tool as an open-source solution so that individual users and organizations can self-host on-premises and own all of their data. Future work should assess the risks and integrate guardrails and safety mechanisms to prevent adversarial attacks by agents in the system.

**Inclusivity and access.**

MobileAgent is a mobile agent management platform balancing automation, control, and usability. Our limited evaluation with 13 students shows a tension between control and efficiency. The participants voted the live execution graph as the feature that built the most trust when delivered together with the plan proposal. They also selected voice-input as an unlocking feature for hands-free use, but recognized the necessity for text and the benefits of images. Participants found the agent toggles an easy-to-use and effective feature, while the constitution remains a feature for power users. Ultimately, all control and modality options remain available in settings, with multimodal and transparency modes as defaults, supporting high levels of customization without overwhelming new users with complex settings. A, such as the constitution and the bring-your-own agent architecture, arentrollers will be essential to maintaining meaningful human oversight and interactivity.

**Conclusion.**

# References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[7] Peter Steinberger. 2025. Clawdbot: Personal AI Assistant. https://clawd.bot Open-source autonomous AI agent; later renamed OpenClaw.

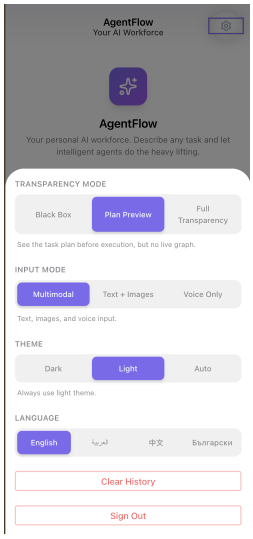

# A Project Structure

```
agentflow/
+-- package.json          # Monorepo scripts
+-- client/
|   \-- src/
|       +-- App.tsx       # Root (auth, theme, RTL)
|       +-- index.css     # Tailwind + animations
|       +-- state/
|       |   \-- store.ts  # Zustand (state + API)
|       +-- types/        # TS interfaces
|       +-- i18n/         # 4 languages (en/zh/ar/bg)
|       \-- components/
|           +-- Chat/     # Chat + markdown + TTS
|           +-- Agents/   # List + detail + toggle
|           +-- Graph/    # ReactFlow DAG + nodes
|           +-- TaskPlan/ # Plan card + approval
|           +-- Camera/   # Image capture + consent
|           +-- Voice/    # Recording + consent
|           +-- Settings/ # Transparency/theme/i18n
|           +-- Execution/# History + step stream
|           \-- Privacy/  # Consent dialog
+-- server/
|   +-- main.py           # FastAPI + CORS + routers
|   +-- config.py         # Pydantic settings
|   +-- auth.py           # Supabase JWT auth
|   +-- routers/
|   |   +-- chat.py       # POST /api/chat
|   |   +-- execute.py    # POST /api/execute (SSE)
|   |   +-- approve.py    # Checkpoint approval
|   |   +-- agents.py     # Agent CRUD
|   |   \-- conversations.py # Conversation CRUD
|   +-- crew/
|   |   +-- orchestrator.py # Planning + graph
|   |   +-- agents.py      # Backstories
|   |   \-- tools.py       # Tool implementations
|   +-- models/
|   |   +-- messages.py   # ChatRequest/Response
|   |   +-- tasks.py      # TaskPlan/TaskStep
|   |   \-- graph.py      # Graph state models
|   \-- services/
|       +-- execution_tracker.py # Dependency exec
|       +-- image_analyzer.py    # GPT-4.1 vision
|       +-- audio_transcriber.py # Whisper
|       +-- agent_store.py       # JSON agent CRUD
|       +-- db.py                # Supabase DB layer
|       \-- supabase_client.py   # Supabase client
```

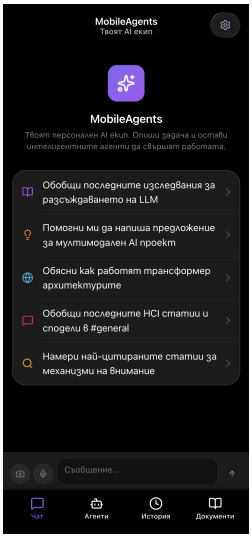
# B System Prompts

## B.1 Orchestrator Backstory

```
You are a concise research librarian orchestrating
an academic team. Keep all outputs brief — this is
a mobile app with limited screen space.

Break requests into the fewest steps needed.
Prefer parallel execution.
Use uncertainty-aware language when appropriate.

Produce structured JSON plans. Do not add
unnecessary steps.

Available agents:
- arxiv: ArXiv Research Analyst —
    capabilities: arxiv_search, arxiv_summarize
- proposal: Research Proposal Strategist —
```




(a) Settings panel




(b) Bulgarian localisation

**Figure 6: Settings and localisation screens. (a) Settings exposes all three transparency modes, input modes (Multimodal / Text+Images / Voice Only), theme (Dark/Light/Auto), and language (EN/AR/ZH/BG). (b) Bulgarian localisation: the full UI—including navigation labels and suggested queries—renders in Bulgarian with full RTL support for Arabic (not shown).**

```
    capabilities: generate_proposal,
    outline_methodology
- wikipedia: Background Research Specialist —
    capabilities: wiki_search, wiki_summarize
- slack: Slack Messenger —
    capabilities: slack_send_message
    [requires_approval]
- semantic_scholar: Citation Analyst —
    capabilities: semantic_scholar_search,
    semantic_scholar_cite

Constitution (user-defined guidelines):
<user-editable free text appended here>
```

## B.2 Planning Task Prompt

```
Analyze the following user request and create a
structured execution plan.

User request: {user_message}

[Image analysis: {image_analysis}]
[Audio transcript: {audio_transcript}]
[Conversation history: {history}]

Input modality: {input_modality}
{modality_note}

Available agents:
{agent_descriptions}

Rules:
- Match the user's request to the most appropriate
  agent(s). Agents are NOT limited to research —
  some send messages, perform actions, etc.
- For agents marked [requires_approval], set
  requires_approval=true on that step. For all
  other agents, set requires_approval=false.
- Only return an empty steps list if the request
  truly cannot be handled by ANY available agent
  (e.g. "hello", pure casual chat).
- If steps are independent, leave depends_on empty
  so they can run in parallel.
- If a step needs output from another step, add
  that step's ID to depends_on.
- Always prefer parallel execution when possible.
- Use step IDs like "step_1", "step_2", etc.
- agent_id must be one of: {valid_agent_ids}
- Use exact param names from tool signatures.
  For slack_send_message use params:
  {"channel": "<channel>", "text": "<message>"}
- If image analysis is provided, use that content
  to inform search queries and proposal topics.
- If audio was transcribed, treat the transcript
  as the primary user intent.
- If conversation history is provided, use it to
  resolve ambiguous references.
```

## B.3 Synthesis Prompt

**System prompt:**

```
You are a research orchestrator synthesizing agent
results for a MOBILE interface. Responses are read
on small screens.

Guidelines:
- Be concise: aim for 150-300 words max
- Lead with the key finding or answer in 1-2
  sentences
- Use short bullet points, not long paragraphs
```

```
- Use markdown: **bold** for emphasis, short
  headings, compact lists
- Keep relevant URLs but don't list more than 3-5
- Do NOT mention the agents or internal execution
  process
- Use uncertainty-aware language: 'based on
  available results' rather than absolute claims
- End with a one-line disclaimer: '*Results may
  not be exhaustive — verify for critical
  decisions.*'
```

**User message template:**

```
**User request:** {user_message}

**Plan summary:** {plan_summary}

**Agent results:**

### Agent step: {step_description}
{step_result}

### Agent step: {step_description}
{step_result}
...
```

## B.4 Image Analysis Prompt

```
Analyze this image in the context of a research
assistant. Describe what you see and what research
tasks might be relevant (e.g., paper search,
literature review, proposal generation).
Be concise.
```

# C Agent Backstories

```
[ArXiv Agent]
You are an expert research analyst who monitors arXiv
daily. You can search for papers by topic, summarize
their key findings, and identify trends across recent
publications. You excel at distilling complex papers
into clear, actionable summaries.

[Proposal Agent]
You are a seasoned research strategist who has helped
write dozens of successful grant proposals and research
plans. You understand how to identify research gaps,
formulate compelling research questions, and outline
rigorous methodologies. You synthesize information from
literature into coherent proposals.

[Wikipedia Agent]
You are a thorough background researcher who uses
Wikipedia to gather foundational knowledge on topics.
You find relevant articles, extract key concepts and
definitions, and provide well-structured overviews that
help contextualize research work.

[Slack Agent]
You are a communication specialist who sends messages
to Slack channels on behalf of the team. You craft
clear, well-formatted messages and deliver them to the
correct channels. You always confirm which channel to
post to and summarize what was sent.

[Semantic Scholar Agent]
You are a citation analyst who uses Semantic Scholar to
find papers and assess their impact. You search across
all academic literature (not just arXiv), retrieve
citation counts and influential citation metrics, and
help identify the most impactful work in any research
area.
```

# D Tool Implementations

## D.1 SSE Event Protocol

Execution updates are streamed as Server-Sent Events.

# E Data Schemas

## E.1 Request and Response Models

**ChatRequest** (client → server):

```
{
  "message": "string",
  "image_base64": "string | null",
  "audio_base64": "string | null",
  "input_modality": "text | voice | image",
  "conversation_history": [
    {"role": "user|assistant", "content": "..."}
  ],
  "conversation_id": "string | null"
}
```

**ChatResponse** (server → client):

```
{
  "message": "string",
  "plan": TaskPlan | null,
  "graph": ExecutionGraphState | null,
  "image_base64": "string | null"
}
```

## E.2 Task Plan Models

**TaskPlan**:

```
{
  "id": "string",
  "summary": "string",
  "steps": [TaskStep],
  "status": "proposed | executing | completed",
  "created_at": "ISO 8601"
}
```

**TaskStep**:

```
{
  "id": "step_1",
  "agent_id": "arxiv | proposal | wikipedia
              | slack | semantic_scholar",
  "action": "tool function name",
  "description": "human-readable description",
  "params": { "key": "value" },
  "status": "pending | running | completed
            | failed | awaiting_approval",
  "result": "string | null",
  "requires_approval": false,
  "depends_on": ["step_id"]
}
```

**Table 6: Complete tool registry. Each function is mapped to one or more agents and called directly during execution.**

| Function | Agent | Parameters |
|---|---|---|
| `arxiv_search` | ArXiv | `query`: str, `max_results`: int (default 5) |
| `arxiv_summarize` | ArXiv | `paper_url`: str |
| `generate_proposal` | Proposal | `topic`: str, `context`: str |
| `outline_methodology` | Proposal | `approach`: str, `domain`: str |
| `wiki_search` | Wikipedia | `query`: str |
| `wiki_summarize` | Wikipedia | `title`: str |
| `slack_send_message` | Slack | `channel`: str, `text`: str |
| `semantic_scholar_search` | Sem. Scholar | `query`: str, `max_results`: int (default 5) |
| `semantic_scholar_cite` | Sem. Scholar | `paper_id`: str |

**Table 7: SSE event types streamed during execution.**

| Event type | Payload and semantics |
|---|---|
| `graph_init` | Full `ExecutionGraphState`. Sent once at the start. |
| `node_status` | `nodeId`, `status` (`running` \| `completed` \| `failed` \| `awaiting_approval` \| `approved`), optional `result` and `duration` (ms). |
| `edge_status` | `edgeId`, `status` (`active` \| `completed`). |
| `checkpoint_reached` | `nodeId`, `stepId`. Emitted when an approval-gated step is ready. |
| `execution_complete` | Updated `ExecutionGraphState` and synthesised `summary`. |
| `execution_failed` | `error` message string. |

## E.3 Execution Graph Models

**ExecutionGraphState**:

```
{
  "task_id": "string",
  "nodes": [GraphNode],
  "edges": [GraphEdge],
  "current_node_id": "string | null",
  "status": "planning | executing
            | completed | failed"
}
```

**GraphNode**:

```
{
  "id": "string",
  "type": "input | orchestrator | agent
          | checkpoint | output",
  "data": {
    "label": "string",
    "type": "...",
    "status": "pending | running | completed
              | failed | awaiting_approval
              | approved | skipped",
    "agent_id": "string | null",
    "agent_color": "#hex | null",
    "agent_icon": "LucideIconName | null",
    "result": "string | null",
    "duration": "milliseconds | null",
    "input_modality": "text|voice|image | null",
    "timestamp": "ISO 8601 | null"
  },
  "position": { "x": 0, "y": 0 }
}
```

**GraphEdge**:

```
{
  "id": "e-source-target",
  "source": "node_id",
  "target": "node_id",
  "data": {
    "status": "pending | active | completed",
    "data_preview": "string | null"
  }
}
```

# F Agent Registry Schema

```
{
  "id": "unique_string",
  "name": "Display Name",
  "icon": "LucideIconName",
  "description": "Short description",
  "role": "CrewAI role string",
  "goal": "CrewAI goal string",
  "backstory": "Full system prompt text",
  "capabilities": ["tool_1", "tool_2"],
  "enabled": true,
  "requiresApproval": false,
  "color": "#hex",
  "isOrchestrator": false,
  "constitution": ""
}
```

# G CSS Animations and Theming

## G.1 Theme Variables

**Table 8: Theme colour tokens (selected).**

| Token | Light | Dark |
|---|---|---|
| `-surface-0` | `#ffffff` | `#000000` |
| `-surface-1` | `#f2f2f7` | `#1c1c1d` |
| `-surface-2` | `#e5e5ea` | `#121212` |
| `-text-primary` | `#000000` | `#ffffff` |
| `-text-secondary` | `#3c3c43` | `#ffffffcc` |

# H Survey Instrument

All Likert items use a 7-point scale (1 = Strongly Disagree, 7 = Strongly Agree) unless otherwise noted.

## Part 0: Background (before study begins)

(1) Age range. *(18–21 / 22–25 / 26–30 / 31–40 / 40+)*
(2) Gender. *(Male / Female / Non-binary / Prefer not to say)*
(3) How often do you use AI assistants (e.g., ChatGPT, Copilot)? *(Daily / Several times a week / Weekly / Monthly / Rarely or Never)*
(4) Have you used a multi-agent AI system before? *(Yes / No / I'm not sure)*
(5) Which AI tools do you use regularly? *(Select all: ChatGPT, Copilot, Gemini, Claude, Cursor, Perplexity, Other)*

## Part 1: After each transparency condition (C1, C2, C3) — RQ1

Completed three times, once per configuration. Items 1–3 are primary metrics; items 4–7 are supplementary.

(1) I trusted the system's output enough to act on it. *(Trust)*
(2) I felt in control of what the system did on my behalf. *(Perceived Control)*
(3) I am satisfied with this interaction. *(Satisfaction)*
(4) The system made it clear what it was going to do before doing it. *(Expectation Setting)*
(5) It was easy to correct or stop the system when needed. *(Repairability)*
(6) I understood why the system made the decisions it did. *(Explainability)*
(7) I felt comfortable with the information I shared during this task. *(Privacy Comfort)*
– Any comments about this mode? *(open text, optional)*

After all three conditions:

8. Which transparency mode would you prefer for everyday use? *(C1 Blackbox / C2 Plan Preview / C3 Full Transparency)*
9. Which mode would you prefer for high-stakes tasks (e.g., sending a Slack message on your behalf)? *(C1 / C2 / C3)*
10. Why did you prefer that mode? *(open text, optional)*

## Part 2: After each modality condition (M1, M2, M3) — RQ2

Completed three times, once per modality (text, image, voice). The NASA-TLX uses a 1–10 scale (Very Low–Very High); Performance is reversed (1 = Perfect, 10 = Failure).

**Single Ease Question (SEQ):**

(1) Overall, how would you rate the difficulty of this task? *(1 = Very Difficult, 7 = Very Easy)*

**NASA Task Load Index [3]:**

2. Mental Demand — How much mental and perceptual activity was required? *(1–10)*
3. Physical Demand — How much physical activity was required? *(1–10)*
4. Temporal Demand — How much time pressure did you feel? *(1–10)*
5. Performance — How successful were you in accomplishing the task? *(1 = Perfect, 10 = Failure)*
6. Effort — How hard did you have to work to accomplish the task? *(1–10)*
7. Frustration — How irritated, stressed, or annoyed did you feel? *(1–10)*

**Modality comfort (7-point Likert):**

8. Using this modality felt natural for this type of task. *(Modality Comfort)*
9. I would use this modality in a public or shared space. *(Context Appropriateness)*
– In what situations would you choose or avoid this modality? *(open text, optional)*

After all three modality conditions:

10. Which input modality would you use most often on a mobile device? *(Text / Voice / Image / It depends)*
11. Which modalities felt well-suited to on-the-go use? *(Select all: Text / Voice / Image)*
– Was there a modality that surprised you – positively or negatively? *(open text, optional)*

## Part 3: After the customisation task (Phase 3) — RQ3

(1) I was able to find the constitution editor without help. *(Discoverability)*
(2) I understood what the constitution field does. *(Mental Model)*
(3) Editing the constitution changed the system's behaviour as I expected. *(Effectiveness)*
(4) The agent on/off toggles were easy to understand and use. *(Controllability)*
(5) After customising the system, I felt more in control. *(Perceived Ownership)*
(6) I would use the constitution and agent controls regularly. *(Adoption Intent)*
7. Which type of change did you make to the constitution? *(Constraint / Style / Routing / Did not edit / Other)*
– Describe what you changed and whether the system behaved as expected. *(open text)*

## Part 4: Overall post-study feedback

(1) Overall, I would trust this system to act on my behalf on a mobile device. *(Overall Trust)*
(2) I felt this system respected my privacy. *(Privacy)*
(3) I would use this application in my day-to-day work. *(Adoption Intent)*
4. Which single feature contributed most to your trust? *(Plan Preview / Checkpoint approval / Live DAG / Agent on/off / Constitution / Multimodal input)*
5. Which single feature caused the most friction or concern? *(Plan approval steps / Live graph overwhelming / Voice risky in shared spaces / Camera awkward / Agent controls hard to find / Constitution unclear)*
– What is the single most important improvement you would make? *(open text)*
– Any other comments or suggestions? *(open text)*

# I Semi-Structured Interview Questions

After completing all three configurations, participants were asked:

(1) You used three different versions of the system. Can you describe how each felt different?
(2) Which version would you prefer for everyday use? Why?
(3) Was there a moment where you particularly trusted—or distrusted—the system? What caused that?
(4) The system showed you a plan before executing. Did that change how you interacted with it? How?
(5) For the version with the live graph, was seeing the execution progress helpful or distracting?
(6) The system required approval before sending a Slack message. How did that approval step feel? Too cautious? About right?
(7) How did you decide whether to use text, voice, or camera input? Were there situations where you avoided a modality? Why?
(8) Did any of the system's responses feel overconfident or uncertain? How did that affect your trust?
(9) If this system stored your conversation history across sessions, how would you feel about that? What controls would you want?
(10) Can you think of a situation where a system like this could cause harm—to you or someone else?
(11) What is the single most important change you would make to improve this system?